

RetailzPOS / Moolah Points — Daily Trending Topics Brief

October 8, 2026

Trending now — 4 topics with a genuine brand angle

#	Trend	Source	Brand-twist content idea
1	Today is the inaugural Top Women in Convenience (TWIC) Connections Luncheon and Awards Gala , held as an official part of the NACS Show in Las Vegas.	EnsembleIQ — TWIC and NACS Show partnership announcement	Instagram/LinkedIn, community-recognition post. Not a pitch — a genuine spotlight: celebrate women running or leading liquor, convenience, and smoke/vape stores today, tagging the event and congratulating anyone in the RetailzPOS network attending or honored. Warm, specific, no CTA needed — recognition content stands on its own.

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2	Gen Z isn't actually going sober — they're drinking differently. Legal-age Gen Z drinking rates rose to 74% (up from 66% in 2023), roughly in line with the overall U.S. adult rate of 76%, while premium spirits is a \$215B+ global category growing ~9.7%/year and the craft segment is projected toward \$16B by 2035.	Newswav — Gen Z Is Off the Wagon, Toast — Top Liquor Store Trends 2026	LinkedIn, merchandising-strategy post. Correct a myth a lot of owners have absorbed secondhand: “Gen Z isn't sober — they're actually drinking at close to the same rate as everyone else, they're just more deliberate about it, and willing to pay more for quality. If your shelf planning has been ‘add a few NA options and call it Gen Z-ready,’ the bigger opportunity might be premium and craft, not just zero-proof.” Data-driven, not promotional.
3	Instagram's Reels teleprompter, first tested in late 2025, has rolled out to the Main Feed — read a script off-screen instead of memorizing it on camera.	Stack Influence — Social Media Updates: TikTok, Instagram & More	Practical production-tip post for owners who avoid video. “The thing stopping most owners from posting video isn't the idea, it's freezing up on camera. Instagram's built-in teleprompter (now live on the main Reels composer) fixes exactly that — write three sentences about what's new on your shelf this week, read them off-screen, done.” Removes a real production barrier for the authentic-video advice we've given before.

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4	The national organized retail crime crackdown is producing real numbers — NRF’s September 17 Blitz across 32 states led to 1,900+ arrests and recovered or prevented \$2M+ in losses; California’s task force alone reports 329 investigations and \$6.3M in recovered property for 2026 so far, with June arrests up 87.5% year-over-year.	NRF — National Organized Retail Crime Crackdown Press Release	LinkedIn, security-awareness post. “Organized retail crime enforcement just posted its biggest numbers yet — which also means these rings are still operating, including in categories like liquor, vape, and CBD that resell easily. Worth asking your POS vendor directly: does it flag unusual inventory-loss patterns at the SKU level, or only give you a total shrink number at month’s end?” A sharper question to ask, not a product claim.

Skipped, no genuine angle today: DoorDash/Instacart alcohol-delivery news (nothing confirmed from 2026 in today’s research — most coverage found was several years old), Diwali retail guidance (sourced almost entirely from UK trade press, not reliable for a U.S. audience without better grounding), and the NRF holiday-spending forecast (NRF hasn’t published its 2026 holiday figure yet — too thin to use responsibly this week).

Compliance check: none of the above imply pricing, encourage overconsumption, or use underage-adjacent framing — #1 is pure recognition content, #2 is data-driven merchandising insight with no health claims, #3 is a production tip, #4 is a vendor-question framing with no product pitch.